

Objects of reference (Non-powered AAC)



Objects of Reference (OOR) is an approach which uses 'real' objects or items to represent people, activities or places



OOR are often used to support those who may not use/understand symbols. They can learn to associate the object with the upcoming event



Since OOR are so personal, they can vary greatly from person to person. For example, one person might associate swimming with the feeling of a towel, so a piece of towel could represent a trip to the pool. Another person might connect swimming with the smell of the pool water, so a container with pool water inside would work best

OOR are not standardised. Everyone experiences the world in different ways. OOR should be individualised, which involves the communication partner carefully considering what part of a place or experience is most meaningful to the person.



Some people may use miniature versions of an object (e.g. toy car); however, this may be more for the communication partners' benefit than the individual, as it likely won't resemble the experience of actually travelling in a car.

